

Test and Procedure Preparation

General rules

Arrive 15 minutes early. Bring a photo ID and your SmartHealth appointment details. Wear loose clothing. Tell the front desk about allergies, pregnancy, kidney disease, and all medicines including supplements. If you feel faint after a blood draw, sit until staff say you may leave.

Fasting blood tests

Many cholesterol, glucose, and metabolic panels need 8 to 12 hours of fasting. Water is usually allowed. Do not eat food, drink juice, or chew gum. Ask your provider before skipping prescribed medicine. If you have diabetes, confirm fasting instructions the day before.

Complete blood count and routine labs

CBC, thyroid tests, and many infection tests do not require fasting. You may eat a normal meal unless your order says otherwise. Drink water so veins are easier to find.

Urine tests

For a standard urine sample, wash hands, use the mid-stream catch, and return the cup to the lab window. For a 24-hour urine collection, start after the first morning void, keep the jug cold, and return it the next morning. Do not skip bottles.

Imaging: X-ray

Remove jewelry and metal from the area being imaged. Tell staff if you could be pregnant. No fasting is needed for a plain X-ray.

Imaging: ultrasound

Abdominal ultrasound often needs 6 hours of fasting. Pelvic ultrasound may require a full bladder: drink water as instructed and do not empty your bladder until the scan is done.

Imaging: CT and MRI

CT with contrast may need kidney labs first and a period without food. Tell staff about iodine or contrast allergy, metformin, and asthma. MRI: no metal implants unless cleared, no magnetic cards in the pocket, and tell staff about claustrophobia. Some MRI scans need contrast.

What to bring and what not to do

Bring previous reports on paper or a USB if you have them. Do not apply lotion or deodorant before some heart tests. Do not book a fasting test late in the day if you cannot skip breakfast. If you miss prep, call the clinic before traveling in; the slot may need reschedule.